

Reading - How to Solve Reading Comprehension Questions

10 original questions | Reading and Writing

Complete the questions before turning to the answer explanations. Mark any guess, even if it turns out to be correct. For math, show your setup and check the requested quantity. For reading, identify the exact supporting detail; for grammar, identify the clause or subject.

These questions were authored for this workbook from the lesson topics. They are not official SAT questions or copies of the course's paid practice.

How to Solve Reading Comprehension Questions | 10 questions

[Lesson video: How to Solve Reading Comprehension Questions](#)

1. Researchers propose that an unfamiliar typeface improves recall only when readers have ample time to study a passage. They predict that, under a strict time limit, the effort needed to decode the typeface will offset any benefit.

Which finding would most directly support the full proposal?

- A) With unlimited study time, readers using either typeface recalled some details.
- B) Readers rated the unfamiliar typeface as harder to read.
- C) Readers given ample time recalled more with the unfamiliar typeface, but readers under a strict limit showed no recall advantage from it.
- D) Readers under a strict limit recalled fewer details than readers given ample time, regardless of typeface.

2. An economist argues that a transit discount produced a larger proportional increase in monthly trips among occasional riders than among frequent riders. The survey data below report average monthly trips before and after the discount.

Which statement most directly supports the argument?

Group	Before	After
Occasional	2	4
Frequent	20	22

- A) Frequent riders made more trips than occasional riders after the discount.
- B) Occasional riders' trips increased by 100%, while frequent riders' trips increased by 10%.
- C) Both groups made more trips after the discount.
- D) Frequent riders made 22 monthly trips after the discount.

3. A museum replaced several descriptive labels with questions intended to prompt discussion. Visitors in the redesigned room spent longer looking at the objects, but the study did not record their conversations or assess their understanding. Thus, while the redesign may have increased attention, the study _____.

Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A) established that every visitor understood the objects better
- B) could not determine whether the labels improved discussion or comprehension
- C) showed that descriptive labels always discourage attention
- D) demonstrated that visitors preferred questions to every other label format

4. Text 1: A scholar contends that a poet's frequent use of unfinished sentences invites readers to supply connections that the poems leave unstated.

Text 2: Another scholar notes that, in the poet's early drafts, many sentences were complete. The poet later removed connecting words, increasing the effort readers must make to follow the poems.

How would the scholar in Text 2 most likely respond to the claim in Text 1?

- A) By suggesting that the drafts support the idea that the poet deliberately increased readers' interpretive role
- B) By arguing that unfinished sentences were accidental errors that the poet never corrected
- C) By asserting that readers cannot understand any of the poems
- D) By claiming that complete sentences require more interpretation than incomplete sentences

5. A paleontologist was reserved in discussing a newly discovered footprint. Although its shape resembled that of a known species, the surrounding rock had been distorted, making a confident identification difficult.

As used in the text, what does "reserved" most nearly mean?

- A) Set aside for future use
- B) Cautious in expressing a conclusion
- C) Unwilling to share any evidence
- D) Certain of an identification

6. The conventional account places the settlement's founding in the tenth century. Charcoal recovered beneath its oldest stone building has recently been dated to the eighth century. The charcoal does not prove that the stone building existed then, but it raises the possibility of earlier activity at the site.

What is the function of the underlined sentence?

- A) It offers new evidence that motivates a qualified challenge to the conventional chronology.
- B) It proves that all buildings in the settlement were built in the eighth century.
- C) It describes an error that the next sentence dismisses entirely.
- D) It explains how charcoal dating was invented.

7. Researchers hypothesize that a bird's ability to locate hidden food depends more on landmarks than on smell.

Which experimental result would most directly weaken the hypothesis?

- A) Removing nearby landmarks had little effect on success, but blocking access to odor cues sharply reduced success.
- B) Birds found visible food more quickly than hidden food.
- C) Birds usually approached the food from the same direction.
- D) The food had a strong odor detectable by humans.

8. A historian studying household inventories found that ceramic plates appeared more often in wealthy households than in poorer ones. She cautions that inventories were compiled mainly for households with property to distribute and may underrepresent the poorest residents.

Which statement would the historian most likely agree with?

- A) The inventories are useless for studying any household.
- B) The observed difference may not fully describe the entire population.
- C) Poor residents certainly owned more plates than wealthy residents.
- D) All inventories were fabricated by wealthy residents.

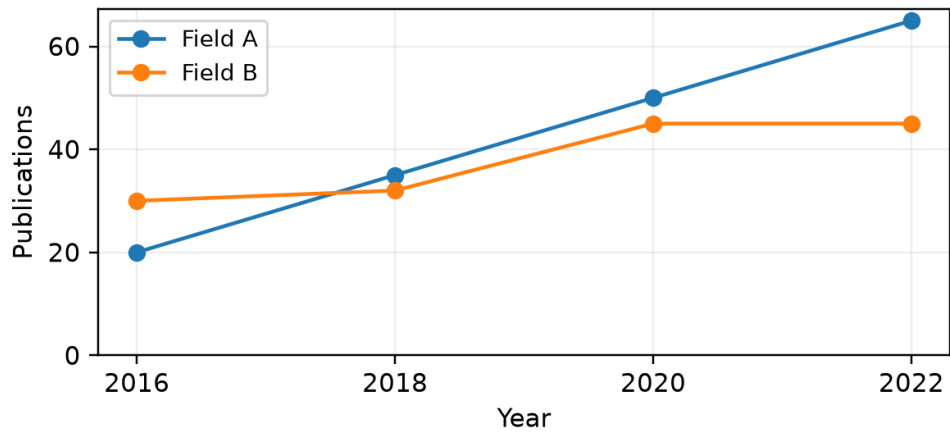
9. In laboratory tests, a coating reduced corrosion on steel samples exposed to saltwater for thirty days. The researchers stress that the test duration was short compared with the years that bridge components remain in service.

Which finding would most directly address the researchers' stated limitation?

- A) The coating can be applied in three colors.
- B) The coating also reduces corrosion during a multi-year saltwater exposure test.
- C) Uncoated samples sometimes showed surface discoloration.
- D) The laboratory used a calibrated measuring instrument.

10. The graph shows annual publication counts for two fields. A researcher claims that Field A's growth was sustained rather than confined to a single jump.

Which observation best supports this claim?



- A) Field A had more publications than Field B in 2022.
- B) Field A's publication count increased in each successive interval shown.
- C) Field B's count was unchanged in the last interval.
- D) The combined count was greatest in 2022.

Answers & explanations

Count correct answers, but also review correct guesses. Redo missed questions after a day without looking at the solution.

1: C 2: B 3: B 4: A 5: B 6: A 7: A 8: B 9: B 10: B

Why each answer works

1. Answer: C. The claim includes both a typeface benefit under ample time and its absence under a strict limit. C tests both. A lacks the comparative advantage, B measures difficulty rather than recall, and D isolates time rather than the interaction.

2. Answer: B. The relative increase is $2/2 = 100\%$ for occasional riders and $2/20 = 10\%$ for frequent riders. B directly compares the effects. Absolute levels and a general increase do not establish which group responded more strongly.

3. Answer: B. The recorded measure is viewing time. Discussion and comprehension were not measured, so the study cannot establish those outcomes. The other answers make unsupported universal or preference claims.

4. Answer: A. The deliberate revisions removed explicit connections and increased reader effort, supporting the proposed interpretive role. B contradicts revision evidence; C and D go beyond or reverse the text.

5. Answer: B. The rock distortion limits certainty, so reserved describes caution in speaking. A uses another meaning; C and D misrepresent the researcher's response.

6. Answer: A. The date creates grounds to consider earlier activity, while the next sentence limits what can be inferred. B overstates, C ignores the retained possibility, and D is unrelated.

7. Answer: A. The result compares the effects of removing each cue and finds odor more influential, directly opposing the proposed relative importance. B and C do not compare cues; D alone does not show how birds use them.

8. Answer: B. The caution concerns sampling coverage and limits generalization. It does not eliminate all usefulness or establish an opposite pattern.

9. Answer: B. The limitation is duration. A multi-year exposure test addresses whether the short-term effect persists. The other findings do not extend the test over the relevant period.

10. Answer: B. The claim is about the pattern within Field A over time. Its counts rise $20 \rightarrow 35 \rightarrow 50 \rightarrow 65$ at every step. The alternatives compare levels, discuss B, or combine fields.

For each missed or guessed question, record the skill, the condition you overlooked, and one specific action for next time.